

What to have ready

Three things to settle and eighteen to gather, before the Google Business Profile is set up. The step-by-step sheet follows once this is done, and every step on it assumes the whole of this list is already in hand.

For Ednar Nankya at Rayla Digital Agency. September 2026.

Settle these three first

Not things to fetch — things to decide. Each is a question Google asks partway through, and there is no good way to work one out mid-form.

Which phone number is the real one

The website publishes +256 764 065 441. The Google listing shows 0746 065441, which is +256 746 065 441 — the middle digits are swapped, so one of the two is wrong. Ring both if you have to. Then make the profile, the website, WhatsApp and every social bio say the identical thing: Google compares the number everywhere it finds Rayla, and trusts a business with two numbers less than one with a number.

Settled when one number is confirmed as the one a person answers, written down in the form +256 7XX XXX XXX.

Whether anyone can sign in to hello@rayladigitalagency.com

The website's forms deliver into that mailbox, so it certainly *receives* mail — but receiving is not the same as being able to log in, and Google sends a six-digit code there that has to be read within minutes. Sign in at mail.zoho.com before setup day and confirm you get an inbox. If hello@ only forwards somewhere else that is fine, as long as you know where.

Settled when you have opened that inbox yourself, or you know exactly which inbox its mail arrives in.

Whether there is an address to give Google

Either answer works. With an address you enter it and then tell Google not to show it; without one you carry on and verify by phone, email or video instead. What matters is knowing which before you start, because the answer changes the route through the form. It must be somewhere Rayla genuinely works from: never a coworking desk, a virtual office, a mailbox service, a PO box, or a friend's address.

Settled when you can either write the full address down, or say plainly that there is not one yet.

The account

Whoever is signed in becomes the owner of the profile, permanently

- ☐ A Google account on hello@rayladigitalagency.com.
Made from the Zoho address rather than a new Gmail. No Gmail inbox is created, nothing about Zoho changes, and the enquiries from the website keep arriving where they arrive now.
- ☐ The Zoho password for that mailbox, tested at mail.zoho.com.
Tested before setup day, not on it. Google's verification code arrives there and expires.
- ☐ 2-Step Verification switched on, with a recovery phone and a recovery email set.
Do this before the profile exists. Recovery runs through the Google account, not the business listing, so without these there is no route back to the profile at all.
- ☐ The password stored where a second person at Rayla can reach it.
In a password manager – not only in your head, and not only on the phone that might be the thing that goes missing.

The details

Typed into the form, so worth having written down word for word

- ☐ The name exactly as it appears on your signage, invoices and URSB registration: Rayla Digital Agency.
Nothing after it. No location, no list of services – that is the fastest route to a suspension there is.
- ☐ The address you will give Google, if there is one.
It stays hidden from customers, so this is for Google's eyes. If the street address is loose, press and hold on the doorway in Google Maps and copy the Plus Code.
- ☐ The phone number you settled on – and the phone itself, with you, on setup day.
- ☐ The website address: <https://www.rayladigitalagency.com>
With the <https://> and with the www. Not the bare domain, not a shortened link, not a Linktree.
- ☐ Opening hours, honestly.
Including Saturday, and whether the office closes over lunch. These get published, and people turn up on them.
- ☐ A description of about 750 characters, drafted before you sit down.
Leading with what Rayla does and where, because that first sentence is all most people read. No phone numbers or web addresses in it – Google strips them and it reads as spam.

- ☐ The list of services, with one line of description each.
This is where Rayla's own words belong, rather than Google's fixed categories.

The pictures

On the laptop before
you start, not hunted for
halfway through

- ☐ A square logo, at least 720 × 720 pixels.
- ☐ A landscape cover photo, at least 1080 pixels wide.
Showing the team or the work rather than a graphic. It is the first thing anyone sees on the profile.
- ☐ Eight to twelve real photographs: the team working, a shoot in progress, edits on a screen, the office from outside.
No stock imagery, no watermarks, nothing that is mostly text. Give the files descriptive names before they are uploaded.

For verification

Google may ask to see
that the business exists.
Have the proof to hand

- ☐ Your URSB certificate of incorporation or registration, and a trading licence if you have one.
On paper or photographed on your phone. If Google queries the name, the name on that certificate is the whole answer.
- ☐ Something tying the business to the address: a tenancy agreement, or a utility bill in the business name.
- ☐ Visible signage or branding at the location.
If there is none, put something up before the day.
- ☐ A charged phone, and forty-five uninterrupted minutes at the place the business works from, in daylight.
If it comes to video verification, that is where it is filmed — one continuous take, no cuts.

When all of it is ticked

Tell us, and the step-by-step sheet follows: thirty-one steps in the order Google asks for them, written to be worked through in one sitting of about ninety minutes. There is no hurry on the date, only on the order — setting up half a profile and coming back to it later is what causes the problems this list exists to avoid.

Rayla Digital Agency hello@rayladigitalagency.com rayladigitalagency.com